

START HERE

# How to talk along

- 1 Pick a card that fits the moment.
- 2 Read it out loud.
- 3 Everyone answers, grown-ups too.
- 4 “Pass” is always allowed.

 **Dinner**

 **Car**

 **Bath**

 **Bedtime**



In the car, a passenger reads. The driver just talks.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 01

**What was the best  
part of your day?  
What was the  
trickiest part?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

**Go first with yours. Kids open up  
when grown-ups share too.**



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 02

**If you could invent a  
brand-new food,  
what would be in it?  
What would you call  
it?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Play along with silly answers. Silly keeps the talk going.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 03

**Who made you  
smile today?  
What did they  
do?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Listen for new names and ask one more question about them.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 04

**If our family had a holiday that was just ours, what would we do on it?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Write down the best idea, and try it for real.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 05

# What's something you're getting better at?



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Notice the effort: "You kept practicing."



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 06

**If you could have dinner with any animal, which one would you pick? What would you talk about?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask one follow-up question before you share your own answer.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 07

**What's one thing  
you'd love to learn  
how to do?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Ask what the very first step might  
be.**



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 08

**If you were in charge of the house for a day, what rule would you make?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Skip the correcting. Ask, “Why that rule?”



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 09

## What's a question you've always wanted to ask me?



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Answer honestly and briefly, then  
ask it back.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 10

## What made you laugh this week?



### GROWN-UP TIP

Laugh along. Retelling a funny moment is storytelling practice.



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 · 11

**If you had a  
superpower just for  
helping people,  
what would it be?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Ask who they would help first.**



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 12

**Describe your  
perfect weekend,  
from breakfast to  
bedtime.**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask for details: "What would it  
smell like? Sound like?"



# Dinner

TABLE TALK

5-12 • 13

**What's something  
kind that someone  
did for you lately?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Say thanks for sharing. It doesn't need to become a lesson.



5-12 • 14

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Would you rather  
drive a bus, fly a  
plane or sail a  
boat? Why?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Side-by-side talk feels easy. Eyes on the road is fine.



5-12 • 15

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Pick someone you  
can see outside.  
Make up a story  
about where they're  
going.**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Take turns adding one sentence each.



5-12 • 16

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**If this car could take  
us anywhere in one  
second, where  
would we go?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Ask what they would pack.**



5-12 • 17

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What song  
should be our  
family's theme  
song?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Let them pick the next song and ask why they like it.



# Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 18

**What's  
something  
you're looking  
forward to?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Share something you're looking forward to as well.



# Car

A PASSENGER READS

5-12 · 19

**If you designed a  
playground, what  
would it have?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to describe it so clearly  
you could draw it.



5-12 · 20

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Pick a color. How many things that color can we spot before we get there?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Count out loud together. Younger kids can point.



5-12 • 21

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What would you do  
if you were the  
grown-up and I  
were the kid today?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Laugh along, then ask what they'd do the same as you.



5-12 • 22

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What's the  
hardest part of  
being a kid right  
now?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Just listen. "That sounds hard" is enough.



5-12 • 23

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**If animals could talk,  
which one would be  
the funniest? What  
would it say?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Do the voices together.**



5-12 • 24

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Tell me about a  
dream you  
remember.**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what they think it meant. There are no wrong answers.



5-12 • 25

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**What's something  
you know a lot  
about? Teach me  
one thing.**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Be the curious student. Ask a real question.



5-12 • 26

# Car

A PASSENGER READS

**Think of an animal.  
I'll ask yes-or-no  
questions until I  
guess it.**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Swap roles so they practice asking the questions.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 · 27

**If you could swim  
with any sea  
creature, which one  
would you choose?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask what it would feel like to touch it.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 28

## What would a fish say about our bathtub?



GROWN-UP TIP

Answer back in your best fish voice.



5-12 • 29

# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**What felt hard  
today? What  
helped?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Warm water and a calm voice make this a gentle time to ask.



5-12 • 30

# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**If a bubble could  
carry a message  
anywhere, what  
would yours say?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Blow the message away together.**



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 31

**What's your  
favorite smell in  
the whole world?  
Why?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Share yours. Smells often bring back stories.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 32

**If you were a  
raindrop, where  
would you want to  
land?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Ask, “And then what happens?”**



5-12 • **33**

# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**Invent a new  
bath toy. What  
does it do?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask them to give it a name and a sound.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 34

# What makes someone a good friend?



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Ask for an example from their day.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 35

**Would you rather  
live under the sea  
or up in the  
clouds?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask about the trickiest part of living there.



5-12 • 36

# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

**You just found a new planet. What's its name, and who lives there?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Build the world together, one detail each.



## Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 · 37

**What's  
something you  
like about  
yourself?**



### GROWN-UP TIP

Leave a pause. Then share  
something you like about them.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 38

**Close your eyes.  
How many sounds  
can you hear right  
now?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Listen quietly first, then compare lists.



# Bath

GROWN-UP STAYS CLOSE

5-12 • 39

**If you shrank to the size of a rubber duck, what would you explore?**



## GROWN-UP TIP

Follow their lead and keep asking, “Then what?”



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • 40

**What are three  
good things  
from today?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Keep it small. A snack, a joke or a sunny minute all count.



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **41**

# What's something you're wondering about?



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**"I don't know. Let's find out tomorrow" is a great answer.**



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **42**

**If you could  
choose tonight's  
dream, what  
would it be?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Speak slowly and softly. Calm voices help everyone wind down.**



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **43**

# Who is someone you're thankful for? Why?



## GROWN-UP TIP

Ask if they'd like to tell that person tomorrow.



**What was a  
brave thing you  
did this week?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Name the feeling: "You felt nervous,  
and you did it anyway."



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **45**

# What's your favorite memory of our family?



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Share one of your favorite memories of them.



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • 46

**If your stuffed  
animal could talk,  
what would it say  
about your day?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Let the toy answer in its own voice.**



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **47**

**What's something  
you'd like to do  
together this  
weekend?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Pick one idea and put it on the calendar.



**Was there  
anything that  
worried you  
today?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Listen first. Solutions can wait until morning.**



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **49**

**Start a story:**  
**“Once upon a time,  
a tiny dragon..”**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Take turns adding one line until  
someone yawns.



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • 50

**What would you  
love to be really  
good at when you  
grow up?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

**Ask what they love about it.**



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **51**

**If today were  
weather, what  
would it be? Sunny,  
cloudy, stormy?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

Accept every answer. Feelings  
aren't right or wrong.



**Bedtime**

WIND-DOWN TALK

5-12 • **52**

**What do you  
want to  
remember about  
today?**



**GROWN-UP TIP**

End with the same goodnight words every night.

MAKE IT YOURS



# Your own question

## OUR QUESTION

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### GROWN-UP TIP

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For:

Dinner

Car

Bath

Bedtime